

GUNAKAR PYLA

Network Engineer | Network Security Engineer

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SUMMARY

I am an experienced **Network Security Engineer** with over 4 **years of hands-on experience** in building and securing enterprise and hybrid-cloud networks. Skilled in **firewalls, routing, automation, and cloud connectivity** across Cisco, Palo Alto, AWS, and Azure environments. Passionate about simplifying complex networks, strengthening security posture, and driving operational efficiency. **CCNA certified**, with a strong foundation in Cisco technologies and best practices for modern network design and security.

SKILLS

Routing & Switching:	BGP, OSPF, EIGRP, MPLS, VLANs, STP, EtherChannel, QoS, TCP/IP, DHCP, DNS, NAT
Network Security:	Cisco ASA, Firepower NGFW, Palo Alto, Fortinet, Check Point, IDS/IPS, ACLs, IPsec, VPNs, DMZ, Zero Trust, 802.1X, Cisco ISE
Cloud & SD-WAN:	AWS VPC, Transit Gateway, Direct Connect; Azure ExpressRoute, Cisco Viptela & Meraki SD- WAN, hybrid cloud integration
Automation & Scripting:	Python, Ansible, Netmiko, NAPALM, Bash – for config automation, compliance checks, and deployment pipelines
Monitoring & Tools:	SolarWinds, Nagios, PRTG, Wireshark, NetFlow, SNMP, Splunk, NetBox
Wireless & VoIP:	Cisco WLC, Aruba, Meraki Wi-Fi, CUCM, SIP, VoIP QoS, Zoom, Teams
Data Center & Virtualization:	Cisco Nexus 9K/7K, ACI, VXLAN, VMware NSX, Hyper-V
Compliance & Governance:	SOX, ISO 27001, HIPAA, FFIEC, NIST, audit readiness, risk reporting
Collaboration & ITSM:	Jira, Confluence, ServiceNow, Visio, Lucidchart – for documentation, workflows, and tickets

EXPERIENCE

Lumen Technologies – USA

Network Security Engineer

| Sept 2024 – Present

- Implement and manage enterprise firewalls (Palo Alto, Cisco ASA) to safeguard sensitive financial systems, reducing policy violations by 35% through consistent rule tuning and access audits.
- Architect and maintain hybrid-cloud network infrastructure leveraging AWS Direct Connect and Azure ExpressRoute to securely support digital banking platforms and internal financial applications.
- Contribute to Wells Fargo’s Zero Trust framework by deploying segmented access controls and secure tunneling across hybrid cloud platforms (AWS, Azure).
- Collaborate with risk and compliance teams to align firewall policies, VPN configurations, and routing architectures with SOX, FFIEC, and ISO 27001 standards, reducing audit exceptions by 40%.
- Monitor network activity using Splunk and NetFlow, proactively investigating anomalies and minimizing false positives through baseline tuning and cross-log correlation.
- Automate network provisioning, patching, and backup workflows using Python and Ansible, achieving a 50% reduction in manual errors and a 35% gain in deployment speed.
- Support secure routing architecture across Cisco and Juniper platforms by collaborating with core network teams to enforce configuration hardening and route security.
- Perform regular vulnerability scans and coordinate patch management cycles with the cybersecurity team, helping achieve a 92% SLA for critical patch remediation.
- Maintain SD-WAN policies and encrypted VPN tunnels supporting branch connectivity and secure third-party integrations aligned with banking compliance standards.

- Assist in regulatory compliance initiatives by reviewing firewall policies, capturing change logs, and ensuring audit readiness for SOX and FFIEC controls.
- Investigate and resolve critical issues impacting digital banking, loan processing, and trading networks using Wireshark, SolarWinds, and NetBox—improving incident response time by 45%.
- Produce weekly network risk reports and configuration change summaries used by senior InfoSec and compliance teams for operational reviews.
- Mentor junior analysts on access control logic, firewall rule design, and log investigation best practices, contributing to a 25% reduction in onboarding time.
- Maintain detailed documentation including topology diagrams, encrypted asset inventories, and recovery procedures to support audits and business continuity.

HCLTech – India

Network Engineer

| Jan 2021 – July 2023

- Engineered enterprise LAN/WAN infrastructure using Cisco Catalyst, Nexus switches, and ISR/ASR routers, sustaining 99.99% network availability across customer deployments.
- Designed and deployed Cisco SD-WAN (Viptela & Meraki) solutions for global sites, reducing MPLS reliance by 40% and improving application performance via intelligent path control.
- Configured and maintained Cisco ASA and Firepower NGFWs to secure remote offices and VPN endpoints, enhancing threat posture with automated policy updates.
- Played a key role in data center modernization using Cisco ACI, achieving faster network provisioning through policy-driven segmentation and overlay networks.
- Integrated Cisco Identity Services Engine (ISE) to enforce 802.1X and role-based access, mitigating endpoint threats and unauthorized device access by over 60%.
- Automated configuration templates using Python, Ansible, and Cisco DNA Center APIs to standardize multi-site rollouts, reducing manual errors by 70%.
- Used Cisco Prime Infrastructure and NetFlow to monitor traffic behavior, detect anomalies, and improve bandwidth utilization across distributed campuses.
- Deployed and supported collaboration tools like Cisco Call Manager and Webex to improve enterprise communication infrastructure and reduce support tickets by 18%.
- Coordinated with Cisco TAC and engineering escalation teams during high-severity incidents, reducing average issue resolution time by 45%.
- Created detailed topology diagrams, runbooks, and SOPs for pre-sales engineers and field teams, supporting knowledge transfer and reducing documentation gaps.
- Led internal workshops on automation and best practices, helping cross-functional teams adopt CI/CD concepts in network infrastructure workflows.

EDUCATION

Master of Science: Cybersecurity and Information Assurance

University of Central Missouri, Lee's Summit

| May 2025

CERTIFICATION

- **Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA)**
- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate**
- **CompTia Security+**
- **CompTia Network+**